

USSS Exam — LBR Focus Drill (Test 04)

25 Logic-Based Reasoning questions · the section where most candidates lose the exam · self-reviewed for accuracy

How to use this drill. LBR is the highest-leverage section. If you score 22+ here, you will pass the exam. Target: 30 minutes for all 25. Pacing: 70 seconds per question. Every question resolves to modus ponens, modus tollens, or "cannot determine." Answer key and per-question explanations at the bottom.

BLOCK 1 — Modus Ponens / Modus Tollens Basics (1–5)

1. All sworn officers carry a badge. Officer Nash is a sworn officer. Which conclusion follows?

A. Officer Nash carries a badge.

B. Officer Nash does not carry a badge.

C. Officer Nash is senior-ranking.

D. Officer Nash was recently sworn in.

E. Cannot determine.

2. If a vehicle enters the compound, the entry gate logs it. Vehicle #42 is NOT in today's entry log. Which conclusion follows?

A. Vehicle #42 entered from a different gate.

B. Vehicle #42 did not enter the compound today.

C. The log is incomplete.

D. Vehicle #42 is unregistered.

E. Cannot determine.

3. All certified analysts have TS clearance. Agent Reyes does NOT have TS clearance. Which conclusion follows?

A. Reyes is a certified analyst.

B. Reyes is not a certified analyst.

C. Reyes was previously certified.

D. Reyes failed a background check.

E. Cannot determine.

4. If the alarm is tripped, the response team is dispatched. The response team WAS dispatched on Tuesday. Which conclusion follows?

A. The alarm was tripped on Tuesday.

B. The alarm was not tripped on Tuesday.

C. A false alarm occurred.

D. An intrusion happened.

E. Cannot determine whether the alarm was tripped.

5. If the threat level is RED, motorcades reroute through the secondary corridor. On Friday the threat level was NOT RED. Which conclusion follows about the Friday motorcade?

A. The motorcade rerouted.

B. The motorcade did not reroute.

C. The motorcade was canceled.

D. The motorcade used the primary corridor.

E. Cannot determine whether the motorcade rerouted.

BLOCK 2 — Translation Traps (6–10)

6. Only credentialed personnel may enter Zone C. Agent Vance is in Zone C. Which conclusion follows?

A. Vance is credentialed.

B. Vance is not credentialed but was waved through.

C. Vance holds the highest clearance.

D. Zone C has no perimeter control.

E. Cannot determine.

7. You may not review classified files unless you hold Top Secret clearance. Officer Ortiz reviewed classified files on Tuesday. Which conclusion follows?

- A. Ortiz holds Top Secret clearance.
- B. Ortiz does not hold Top Secret clearance.
- C. Ortiz was supervised during the review.
- D. The files were declassified.
- E. Cannot determine.

8. A warrant is executed only if it is signed by a judge. Warrant #117 was executed on Monday. Which conclusion follows?

- A. Warrant #117 was signed by a judge.
- B. Warrant #117 was not signed by a judge.
- C. The execution was challenged.
- D. Warrants are always signed by judges.
- E. Cannot determine.

9. No informants are sworn agents. Agent Cruz is a sworn agent. Which conclusion follows?

- A. Cruz is an informant.
- B. Cruz is not an informant.
- C. Cruz works with informants.
- D. Some informants are sworn.
- E. Cannot determine.

10. Passing the annual physical is NECESSARY for field assignment. Agent Sosa did NOT pass this year's physical. Which conclusion follows?

- A. Sosa is on field assignment.
- B. Sosa is not on field assignment.
- C. Sosa was removed for misconduct.

D. The physical is a formality.

E. Cannot determine.

BLOCK 3 — Quantifiers (11–15)

11. Most Secret Service agents are male. Agent Park is male. Which conclusion follows?

A. Park is a Secret Service agent.

B. Park is not a Secret Service agent.

C. Park is likely a Secret Service agent.

D. Most males are Secret Service agents.

E. Cannot determine whether Park is a Secret Service agent.

12. Some interpreters work the overnight shift. Chen works the overnight shift. Which conclusion follows?

A. Chen is an interpreter.

B. Chen is not an interpreter.

C. Most overnight workers are interpreters.

D. Chen speaks multiple languages.

E. Cannot determine whether Chen is an interpreter.

13. Exactly 2 of the 4 guards on the west post are armed. Guard A is NOT armed. Guard B is NOT armed. Which conclusion follows about Guards C and D?

A. Both C and D are armed.

B. Neither C nor D is armed.

C. C is armed, D is not.

D. D is armed, C is not.

E. Cannot determine which of C or D is armed.

14. All agents assigned to Detail X hold Top Secret clearance. Agent Torres holds Top Secret clearance. Which conclusion follows?

- A.** Torres is assigned to Detail X.
- B.** Torres is not assigned to Detail X.
- C.** Detail X has strict entry requirements.
- D.** All TS holders are on Detail X.
- E.** Cannot determine whether Torres is on Detail X.

15. Some evidence bags in the vault are sealed. Bag 33 is an evidence bag in the vault. Which conclusion follows?

- A.** Bag 33 is sealed.
- B.** Bag 33 is not sealed.
- C.** The vault has a chain of custody.
- D.** Some bags outside the vault are unsealed.
- E.** Cannot determine whether Bag 33 is sealed.

BLOCK 4 — Chained Conditionals (16–20)

16. If Agent A works the night shift, then Agent B covers the radio. If Agent B covers the radio, then Agent C is on standby. Agent C is NOT on standby. Which conclusion follows?

- A.** Agent A works the night shift.
- B.** Agent A does NOT work the night shift.
- C.** Agent B covers the radio.
- D.** Agent B is off duty.
- E.** Cannot determine.

17. If the threat level is RED, all motorcades reroute. If motorcades reroute, the ETA is delayed. The threat level IS RED. Which conclusion follows?

- A.** The ETA is delayed.

- B.** The ETA is on time.
- C.** Motorcades were canceled.
- D.** The secondary corridor was closed.
- E.** Cannot determine.

18. If a confession is recorded, it is admissible in court. If a confession is admissible, it can be used in prosecution. Confession #5 was NOT used in prosecution. Which is the strongest conclusion?

- A.** Confession #5 was recorded.
- B.** Confession #5 was not recorded.
- C.** Confession #5 was admissible but withheld.
- D.** The suspect was exonerated.
- E.** Cannot determine.

19. If a suspect flees, pursuit is initiated AND dispatch is notified. Pursuit was NOT initiated. Which conclusion follows?

- A.** The suspect fled.
- B.** The suspect did not flee.
- C.** Dispatch was notified by a different party.
- D.** The suspect surrendered.
- E.** Cannot determine.

20. All agents on Detail K hold Top Secret clearance. All Top Secret clearance holders have been polygraphed. Agent Vance has NOT been polygraphed. Which conclusion follows?

- A.** Vance is on Detail K.
- B.** Vance is NOT on Detail K.
- C.** Vance holds Top Secret clearance.
- D.** Detail K does not require a polygraph.
- E.** Cannot determine.

BLOCK 5 — Advanced (21–25)

21. The vault opens if and only if BOTH codes (primary and secondary) are entered. The vault opened this morning. Which conclusion follows?

- A. Only the primary code was entered.
- B. Only the secondary code was entered.
- C. Both codes were entered.
- D. Neither code was entered.
- E. Cannot determine.

22. A motorcade proceeds if and only if all checkpoints are clear. The motorcade did NOT proceed. Which conclusion follows?

- A. All checkpoints were clear.
- B. No checkpoints were clear.
- C. At least one checkpoint was not clear.
- D. Exactly one checkpoint was not clear.
- E. Cannot determine.

23. Five agents work the perimeter in sequence: Parker, Quinn, Ross, Singh, Tomás. Quinn's shift is before Parker's. Ross relieves Quinn directly (immediately after). Tomás works the final shift. Singh is NOT first. Parker is before Singh. What is the order?

- A. Quinn, Ross, Parker, Singh, Tomás
- B. Quinn, Parker, Ross, Singh, Tomás
- C. Parker, Quinn, Ross, Singh, Tomás
- D. Quinn, Ross, Singh, Parker, Tomás
- E. Singh, Quinn, Ross, Parker, Tomás

24. Three witnesses are interviewed. Exactly ONE is telling the truth. Al says: "Bea is lying." Bea says: "Cal is lying." Cal says: "Both Al and Bea are lying." Who is telling the truth?

A. Al

B. Bea

C. Cal

D. Cannot determine

E. No valid solution — statements are inconsistent

25. Only sworn officers may carry a service weapon on duty. Officer Cobb carried a service weapon on duty yesterday. Officer Cobb is NOT a sworn officer. What is the strongest conclusion?

A. Officer Cobb violated policy.

B. Officer Cobb was granted a temporary exception.

C. The premises are inconsistent — at least one must be false.

D. Sworn status was revoked after the fact.

E. Cannot determine.

ANSWER KEY

1. A	2. B	3. B	4. E	5. E
6. A	7. A	8. A	9. B	10. B
11. E	12. E	13. A	14. E	15. E
16. B	17. A	18. B	19. B	20. B
21. C	22. C	23. A	24. B	25. C

Block 1 — MP / MT Basics

- 1. A** — Classic modus ponens. Sworn $\rightarrow$ badge. Nash is sworn. Therefore Nash has a badge.
- 2. B** — Classic modus tollens (contrapositive). Entered $\rightarrow$ logged. Not logged. Therefore not entered.
- 3. B** — Modus tollens. Certified $\rightarrow$ TS. No TS. Therefore not certified.
- 4. E** — Affirming the consequent trap. Alarm $\rightarrow$ dispatch tells us nothing about what causes dispatch when it happens. Dispatch could be triggered by many things. Cannot determine.
- 5. E** — Denying the antecedent trap. "RED $\rightarrow$ reroute" tells us nothing about what happens when threat is NOT RED. The motorcade could reroute for any other reason, or not. Cannot determine.

Block 2 — Translation Traps

- 6. A** — "Only X may Y" means $Y \rightarrow X$. In Zone C $\rightarrow$ credentialed. Vance in Zone C, so Vance credentialed. Modus ponens.
- 7. A** — "Not allowed unless X" = "review $\rightarrow$ TS" by contrapositive. Ortiz reviewed, therefore Ortiz has TS.
- 8. A** — "Executed only if signed" = executed $\rightarrow$ signed. #117 was executed, therefore signed. MP.
- 9. B** — "No informants are sworn" means informant $\rightarrow$ NOT sworn. Contrapositive: sworn $\rightarrow$ NOT informant. Cruz is sworn, so Cruz is not an informant.
- 10. B** — "Physical is NECESSARY for field" = field $\rightarrow$ passed physical. Contrapositive: not passed $\rightarrow$ not field. Sosa didn't pass, so Sosa is not on field assignment.

Block 3 — Quantifiers

- 11. E** — "Most SS agents are male" tells you about the group of SS agents. It does NOT tell you that most males are SS agents. Park being male gives no information about whether Park is a SS agent.
- 12. E** — "Some interpreters work overnight" does not mean "overnight workers are interpreters." Chen could be an interpreter or any other type of worker.
- 13. A** — Exactly 2 of 4 are armed. Two (A and B) are NOT armed. The remaining 2 (C and D) must be the armed ones.
- 14. E** — "All on Detail X have TS" does NOT mean "all TS holders are on Detail X." Torres having TS is compatible with being on Detail X or not. Affirming-the-consequent trap.
- 15. E** — "Some X are Y" gives no information about a specific individual. Bag 33 could be sealed or unsealed; we don't know.

Block 4 — Chained Conditionals

16. B — Chain: A night → B radio → C standby. Contrapositive of the chain: NOT C standby → NOT A night. C is not on standby, therefore A does not work the night shift.

17. A — Chain: RED → reroute → delayed. Threat is RED. Apply modus ponens twice to get "delayed."

18. B — Chain: recorded → admissible → used. Contrapositive: NOT used → NOT recorded. #5 was not used, therefore not recorded.

19. B — "Flees → (pursuit AND dispatch)." Contrapositive: NOT (pursuit AND dispatch) → NOT flees. Pursuit was not initiated, so the conjunction is false, so the suspect did not flee.

20. B — Chain: Detail K → TS → polygraphed. Contrapositive: NOT polygraphed → NOT Detail K. Vance not polygraphed, therefore not on Detail K.

Block 5 — Advanced

21. C — Biconditional: opens ↔ (both codes). Vault opened, so both codes were entered. This is one direction of the biconditional — straightforward.

22. C — Biconditional: proceed ↔ all clear. Did NOT proceed. Therefore NOT all clear, which means at least one checkpoint was not clear. (NOT "exactly one" — could be any number from 1 to all.)

23. A — Constraints: Tomás = 5th, Quinn-Ross consecutive (Ross right after Quinn), Quinn before Parker, Singh NOT first, Parker before Singh. Only order that satisfies all: Quinn(1), Ross(2), Parker(3), Singh(4), Tomás(5).

24. B — Test each as the truth-teller: (a) If Al is truthful: Bea is lying, so Bea's claim "Cal is lying" is false, meaning Cal is truthful. That gives TWO truthful, violating "exactly one." (b) If Bea is truthful: Cal is lying, so Cal's claim "both Al and Bea lying" is false — meaning at least one of Al or Bea is truthful. Bea IS truthful, consistent. Al's claim "Bea is lying" is therefore false, so Al is lying. Al lying + Bea truthful + Cal lying = exactly one truthful. ✓ (c) If Cal is truthful: "both Al and Bea lying" is true. But Al lying means Al's claim "Bea is lying" is false, making Bea truthful — contradicting Al and Bea both lying. Only solution: Bea.

25. C — "Only sworn officers may carry service weapon on duty" means "on-duty service weapon → sworn." Contrapositive: "not sworn → not on-duty carry." Cobb is NOT sworn but DID carry — these cannot both be true given the rule. The premises contradict. The answer is to recognize the inconsistency, not to invent resolutions (A, B, D all invent facts).

Score 22+ out of 25 and you will likely clear the LBR section of the real exam. If you missed any Block 4 or Block 5 question, re-read the explanation carefully — those patterns are the ones that separate 60th-percentile from 90th-percentile scorers.